



CHAPTER ONE



Introduction: the first 90 days



Chapter Summary

The first 90 days in a new role are crucial for determining success or failure. Many leaders fail during transitions due to a lack of preparation and understanding of their new responsibilities. Early decisions and credibility matter significantly, making it essential to secure early wins and build supportive relationships. Transitioning leaders must be aware of common traps that can lead to derailment.

Creating positive momentum often leads to long-term success and effectiveness in a new position. This chapter sets the stage for actionable strategies to navigate transitions effectively.



THE CRITICAL FIRST 90 DAYS



In any new role, the first 90 days are pivotal. This timeframe can make or break your career, determining if you successfully adapt or struggle. Your initial actions will significantly influence how others perceive your capability as a leader.

THE IMPACT OF TRANSITIONS



Transitions are a common yet challenging experience for leaders. Almost 90 percent of HR leaders recognize that these times are fraught with difficulties, impacting not only individual performance but overall organizational success.



BUILDING CAREER COMPETENCE

Mastering transitions is essential as career paths become less linear. Leaders frequently shift roles and companies, making the ability to adapt quickly a vital skill for ensuring a successful career.

REACHING THE BREAK-EVEN POINT

The break-even point is where your contributions equal what you've consumed from the organization. It is essential to reach this point swiftly to establish yourself as a valued leader.



AVOIDING COMMON TRAPS

During transitions, leaders must avoid several pitfalls, including relying too heavily on past knowledge, rushing decisions, or neglecting to establish clear expectations with stakeholders. Awareness of these traps can help prevent derailment.



CREATING MOMENTUM

Establish virtuous cycles by making good initial decisions that enhance your credibility. Cultivate relationships that allow you to learn faster and accelerate your effectiveness.

UNDERSTANDING FRAGILE TRANSITIONS

The fundamental causes of transition failures often lie in the interplay between the new role and the individual's adaptability. Leaders must cultivate self-awareness of their strengths and vulnerabilities.

"Success lies not just in the new role, but in your ability to adapt."

PREPARING FOR SUCCESS

Proper preparation forms the backbone of a successful transition. This involves mental readiness, identifying key tasks, and developing an action plan tailored to the new environment.

"Preparation is the first step towards effective leadership."

ACCELERATING LEARNING



Accelerate your understanding of the new role by focusing on crucial aspects of the organization–market, culture, and politics. Create a well-structured learning strategy.

harnessing the 90-day plan



Utilize your first 90 days as a strategic planning horizon. Setting milestones helps ensure traction in the new role and prepares you for sustained success.



Recap

- "In just 90 days, you can either set the stage for success or create a path to failure."
 - "Success or failure in the early days strongly predicts overall job performance."
 - "Mistakes in transitions often stem from old habits and new challenges."
 - "Momentum is built on trust, credibility, and quality decisions."
 - "Success lies not just in the new role, but in your ability to adapt."
- 

Thank You

Follow for more insights

